CONFOEDERATIO,
RESEARCH DIVISION (CRD).

DEMOGRAPHIC HISTORY OF GALICIA AND VOLHYNIA (10000BC - 1300AD)

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (10000BC - 1300AD).

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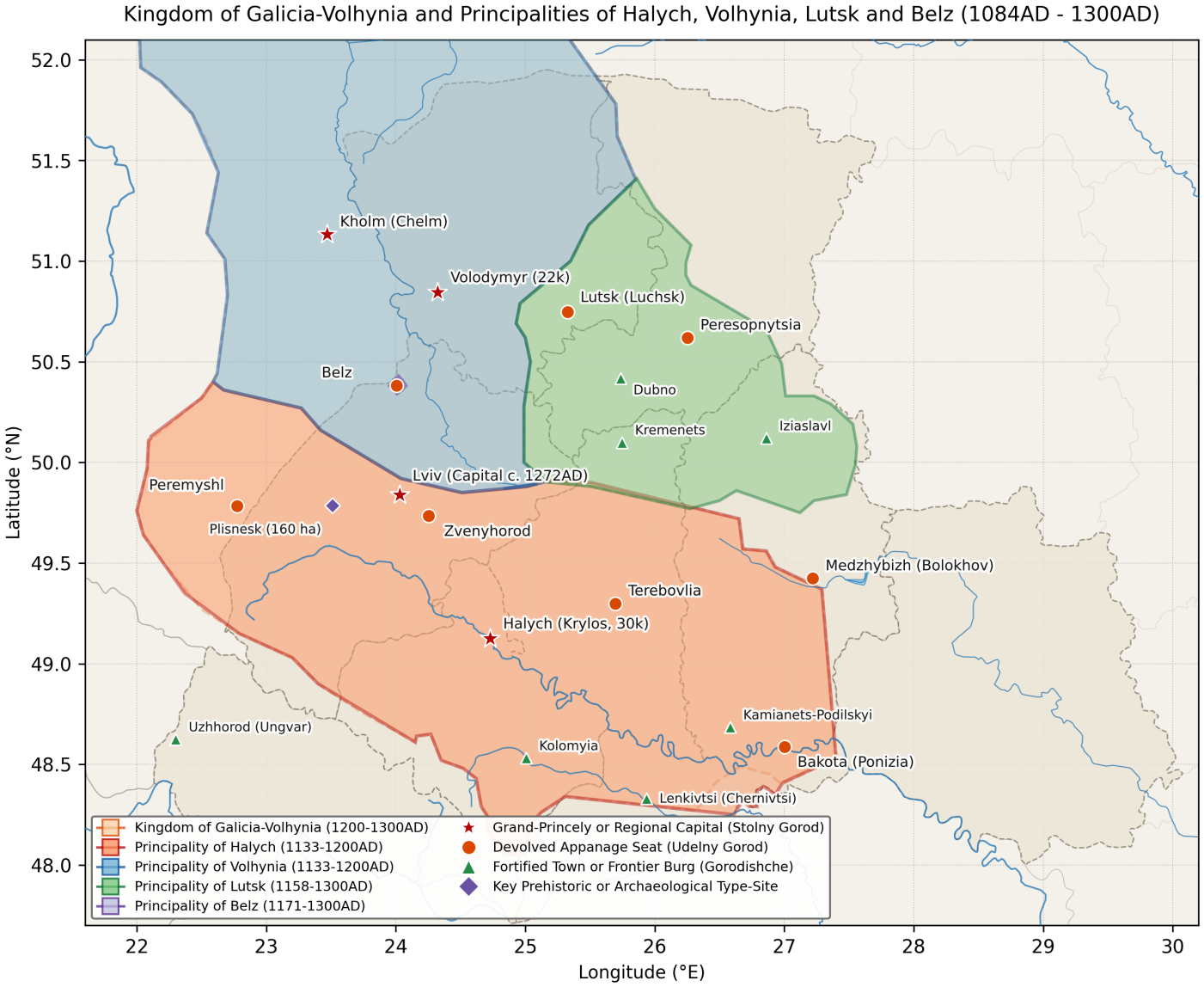


Figure 1. Regional boundaries and fortified settlement hierarchy of the principalities of Galicia, Volhynia, Lutsk, Belz, and Ponizia (10000BC - 1300AD).

Executive Summary and Geographic Scope

This literature review establishes the empirical baseline and settlement-level demographic reconstruction for Galicia and Volhynia in South-Western Rus, book-ended chronologically from the Upper Palaeolithic (10000BC) to the Mongol Conquests (1240-1241AD campaign of Batu Khan across Volhynia and Galicia) and the immediate post-conquest Romanovichi Kingdom of Galicia-Volhynia (Kingdom of Rus, 1250AD - 1300AD) [1][2][3]. Geographically, the region spans nine modern western and right-bank Ukrainian oblasts (~176 200 km^2) across the Upper and Middle Dniester, Western Bug, San, Styr, Horyn, Upper Pripyat, Upper Prut, and Upper Tisza river basins. Historically, this territory formed the south-western march of unified Kievan Rus (981-1133AD) and subsequently partitioned into the Rostislavichi Galician principalities, the Monomakhovichi and Romanovichi Volhynian principalities, and the unified Kingdom of Galicia-Volhynia (1199-1341AD).

The Rostislavichi Galician principalities (49 600 km^2 across Lvivska, Ivano-Frankivska, Ternopilska, and the San-Cherven strip) encompassed the Principality of Peremyshl (1133-1142AD, 49,78°N, 22,77°E), the Principality of Zvenyhorod (1133-1142AD, 49,73°N, 24,25°E), the Principality of Terebovlia (1133-1142AD, 49,30°N, 25,69°E), and the unified Principality of Halych (1133-1200AD, 49,12°N, 24,73°E), consolidated by Vladimirko Volodarevich (1141-1144AD) and Yaroslav Osmomysl (1153-1187AD) around the 200 ha metropolitan complex of Halych (*Krylos*, 30,0k at 1200AD) [4][5][6]. To the north, the Monomakhovichi and Romanovichi Volhynian principalities (40 190 km^2 across Volynska, Rivnenska, and the Left-Bank Western Bug) encompassed the Principality of Volhynia (1133-1200AD, 50,85°N, 24,32°E) centred on Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*, 75 ha, 22,0k at 1200AD) and Daniel's royal capital at Kholm (*Chelm*, 8,0k in 1240AD and 12,0k in 1300AD), the Principality of Lutsk (1158-1324AD, 50,75°N, 25,33°E) across the Styr, Ikva, and Horyn (*Pogoryrina*) basins (*Lutsk* 10,0k, *Peresopnytsia* 5,0k, *Dorogobuzh* 4,5k, *Kremenets* 4,0k, *Iziaslavl*), and the Principality of Belz (1171-1367AD, 50,38°N, 24,01°E; *Belz* 6,0k, *Busk* 4,0k) [2][3][7]. To the south and east, Ponizia (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya, Transcarpathia, and the southern frontier marches (86 410 km^2 across Khmelnytska, Vinnytska, Chernivetska, and Zakarpatska) encompassed the Middle Dniester canyon of Ponizia (*Bakota* 26 ha, 5,5k; *Kamianets* 22 ha, 4,0k; *Ushitsa*, *Kalius*, *Kuchelmin*), the Western Bolokhov Land (*Medzhybizh* 4,0k, *Bozhsky*), Shipenitskaya Zemlya in Northern Bukovina (*Lenkivtsi* or *Chern* on the Prut 3,5k, *Khotyn*), Subcarpathian Rus (*Uzhhorod* or *Ungvar* 3,5k, *Mukachevo*), and historical dynastic links to the Pontic-Crimean outposts of Tmutarakan (988-1100sAD) and Mangup (*Theodoro*, 1204-1300AD) [8][9][10].

Across the Holocene and pre-Mongol medieval era, South-Western Rus experienced four major demographic cycles prior to Batu Khan's 1240-1241AD campaign: (i) the Trypillia-Cucuteni Dniester-Prut-Bug Eneolithic climax (c. 3500BC, 260,0k) anchored by *Bilche-Zolote (Verteba)*, *Koshylivtsi*, *Bodaki*, *Zalishchyky*, and *Stina* [11]; (ii) the Vysotska and Early Scythian West Podolian hillfort horizon (c. 500BC, 490,0k) centred on the 110 ha giant rampart hillfort at *Nemyriv*, *Severynivka*, and *Hryhorivka* [12]; (iii) the Chernyakhov, Lipitsa, Przeworsk, and Carpathian Tumuli Culture optimum (c. 300AD, 680,0k) [13][14]; and (iv) the Galician-Volhynian urban and rural apogee (1000AD - 1200AD), when 350 fortified *gorodishcha* and rich sub-Carpathian salt-boiling centres supported 1,15M in 1000AD, 1,46M in 1100AD, and 1,82M in 1200AD [6][15][16]. Following the 1240-1241AD Mongol destruction of Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Iziaslavl, and Kolodyazhyn, regional population contracted to a post-conquest trough of 1,24M in 1250AD (-31,9% from 1200AD), before recovering under King Daniel Romanovich (crowned 1253AD), Lev Danilovich, and Yuri I Lvovich around the new royal capitals of *Kholm* and *Lviv* to 1,38M in 1300AD [5][17].

Prehistoric and Iron Age Settlement (10000BC - 500AD)

Upper Palaeolithic, Neolithic, and Trypillia-Cucuteni Eneolithic (10000BC - 1500BC)

Unlike the glaciated northern forest basins of European Russia, the deep limestone canyons of the Middle Dniester, Prut, and upper Volhynian uplands functioned as one of Europe's primary periglacial refugia throughout the terminal Pleistocene (10000BC) [18]. Multilayered open-air camp complexes at Molodova I and Molodova V, Korman IV, Babin I, and Voronovitsa along the Dniester canyon, together with the Korolevo sequence on the Tisza in Transcarpathia and Kulychivka (at Kremenets) in Volhynia, preserve continuous Magdalenian and Epigravettian mammoth- and reindeer-hunter horizons supporting a 10000BC regional population of 16,0k (16 000, range 8,0k - 28,0k) [18].

During the Early Holocene (6500BC - 4500BC), indigenous Mesolithic fisher-foragers of the Bug-Dniester Culture (*Soroky*, *Bazkiv Ostriv*, *Pechera*, and *Sokoltsi* on the Southern Bug) adopted early ceramics and domesticated plants through interaction with Linearbandkeramik (LBK) agriculturalists advancing along the Carpathian piedmont into the Upper Dniester and Western Bug loess terraces (*Nezvysko*, *Torskie*, *Zymne*, *Kotiv*, and *Rivne*) [11]. By 5000BC, permanent LBK longhouse villages and Bug-Dniester riverine settlements supported 65,0k (65 000) inhabitants.

Between 4200BC and 3000BC, the Dniester-Prut-Southern Bug plateaus and southern Volhynian uplands formed the western heartland of the Trypillia-Cucuteni Culture (Stages BI-BII and CI-CII), with over 800 documented settlements [11]. Along the Upper and Middle Dniester loess terraces, multiphase promontory settlements and ritual labyrinth caves flourished at Bilche-Zolote (Verteba Cave, 2,5k), Koshylivtsi-Oboz (2,5k), Zalishchyky (2,2k), Nezvysko (1,8k), Horodnytsia (1,8k), Buchach (1,6k), and Polivanov Yar (1,5k) [11]. In the Volhynian-Horyn flint-mining and workshop zone, Late Trypillian (CI-CII) fortified promontory settlements at Bodaki on the Horyn (2,0k), Zymne, Khoriv, and Lystvyn mined and exported high-grade Turonian dark flint blades across the Carpathian-Pontic region [11]. Further east along the Podolian and Southern Bug corridor, large concentric-plan settlements at Stina (3,0k), Nemyriv (2,2k), and Klishchiv (2,0k) bridged the Dniester valley and the Bug-Dnieper mega-site zone.

At the 3500BC Eneolithic benchmark, the regional population reached 260,0k (260 000, range 180,0k - 360,0k). During the Early and Middle Bronze Age (2500BC - 1200BC), pastoral Corded Ware (*Pidkarpatska kultura shnurovoi keramiky*), Komariv (centred on *Komariv* near Halych, exploiting sub-Carpathian salt springs and Transylvanian bronze trade), and Noua communities expanded across the Carpathian piedmont and Volhynian forest-steppe, raising regional population to 310,0k (310 000) at 1500BC [6].

Scythian West Podolian Hillforts and the Chernyakhov Optimum (500BC - 500AD)

In the Early Iron Age (700BC - 300BC), the Hallstatt-influenced Vysotska Culture (Lvivska and Ternopilska oblasts) and the Early Scythian West Podolian Group along the Middle Dniester and Southern Bug erected monumental earthen-rampart hillforts [12]. The paramount regional stronghold was the Nemyriv Giant Hillfort (*Nemyrivske horodyshche*, 48,97°N, 28,84°E), enclosed by 9 m-high ramparts (5,5 km perimeter) encompassing 110 ha, with Milesian and Attic black-glazed pottery (6th - 5th centuries BC) and an estimated population of 4,5k (4 500) [12]. Alongside sister hillforts at Severynivka (2,5k), Hryhorivka (2,2k), Chornoliska, and Vysotske, South-Western Rus supported 490,0k (490 000) inhabitants at 500BC.

During the Roman Imperial period (100AD - 400AD), the Lipitsa (Dacian-Thracian salt-workers of the Upper Dniester), Przeworsk, Wielbark (along the Western Bug and Styr), Carpathian Tumuli, and Zubrytska cultures coalesced in the 3rd - 4th centuries AD into the provincial-Roman agricultural expansion of the Chernyakhov Culture [13][14]. Excavations at Ripniv II, Lepesivka, Bovshiv, Demianiv, Cherneliv-Ruskyi, Bakota, and Sokol document heavy iron-shod plough cultivation, rotary querns,

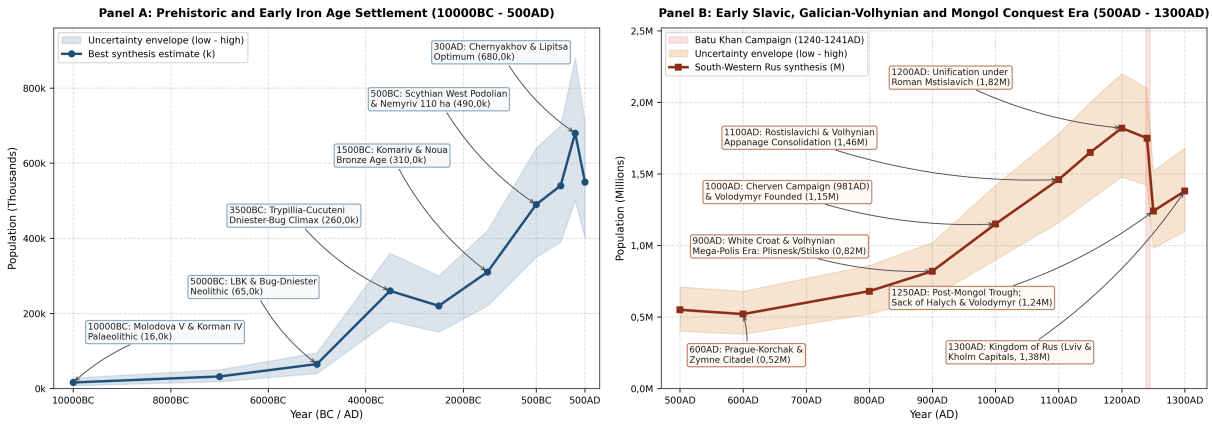


Figure 2. Demographic trajectory of South-Western Rus across Galicia, Volhynia, and Ponizia from the Upper Palaeolithic to 1300AD (10000BC - 1300AD).

glass-working kilns, and Roman denarius hoards, driving the regional population to an antique optimum of 680,0k (680 000) at 300AD [13].

Table 1. Prehistoric, antique, and early Slavic demographic trajectory across the sub-regions of South-Western Rus (10000BC - 900AD).

Benchmark	Galicia Core (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Terebovlia)	Volhynia, Lutsk & Belz	Ponizia (Podolia) & Bolokhov West	Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total (Range)
10000BC	6,0k	4,0k	4,0k	2,0k	16,0k (8 - 28k)
5000BC	26,0k	18,0k	14,0k	7,0k	65,0k (40 - 95k)
3500BC	105,0k	65,0k	62,0k	28,0k	260,0k (180 - 360k)
1500BC	125,0k	85,0k	65,0k	35,0k	310,0k (220 - 420k)
500BC	195,0k	125,0k	120,0k	50,0k	490,0k (350 - 640k)
300AD	275,0k	180,0k	155,0k	70,0k	680,0k (500 - 880k)
600AD	215,0k	145,0k	105,0k	55,0k	520,0k (380 - 680k)
800AD	340,0k	215,0k	80,0k	45,0k	680,0k (520 - 860k)
900AD	415,0k	260,0k	95,0k	50,0k	820,0k (640 - 1 020k)

Early Slavic and Galician-Volhynian Era (600AD - 1300AD)

Prague-Korchak Strongholds and Tribal Mega-Polis Centres (600AD - 980AD)

Following the post-Chernyakhov restructuring (5th - 6th centuries AD), the Upper Dniester, Western Bug, and Styr-Horyn basins became the primary core of the Early Slavic Prague-Korchak Culture (520,0k regional population at 600AD) [14][19]. At Zymne on the Luha River near Volodymyr (50,80°N, 24,33°E), V. V. Aulikh excavated a 6th - 7th century AD timber-palisaded citadel (1,5k inhabitants) yielding non-ferrous jewellery moulds, iron weapons, silvered belt mounts, and Byzantine coins of Justinian I and Justin II (527-578AD), destroyed during the Avar wars against the *Duliby* [19]. Contemporaneous early Slavic settlements flourished at Ripniv, Bovshiv, Zelene, Krylos, and Rashkiv [14].

During the Luka-Raikovetska tribal era (800AD 680,0k; 900AD 820,0k), the White Croats, Volhynians, Buzhany, and Tivertsi constructed monumental polycentric hillforts (*gorodishcha*): Plisnesk (160 ha across seven defensive rampart lines, 6,0k in 900AD) [20], Stilsko (200 ha enclosure on the Kolodnytsia with 10 km of ramparts, 7,0k in 900AD), Old Halych (*Krylos*, 4,5k in 900AD), Revne (2,5k), Volyn (*Grudek*, 3,5k), Cherven (3,0k), Busk (*Buzhsk*, 2,5k), and Peremyshl (3,5k) [2][6][9]. After Grand Prince Vladimir the Great's 981AD Cherven campaign, his 992AD Croat campaign, and the foundation of Volodymyr (988AD), regional

population reached 1,15M (1 150,0k) at 1000AD [2].

Devolved Principalities of Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod, Terebovlia, Volhynia, Lutsk, and Belz (1084AD - 1200AD)

Between 1084AD (when the Rostislavichi brothers established independent rule in Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod, and Terebovlia, ratified at the 1097AD Council of Liubech) and 1199AD (when Roman Mstislavich united Galicia and Volhynia), South-Western Rus developed the densest network of fortified towns in Kievan Rus, with 350 excavated *gorodishcha* catalogued by A. V. Kuza and B. P. Tomenchuk: 92 in Halych and Terebovlia, 64 in Peremyshl and Zvenyhorod, 78 in Volhynia and Belz, 68 in Lutsk and Pogoryrina, and 48 in Ponizia and Bukovina [6][16][21].

In the Galician lands, the Principality of Halych (1133-1200AD, 49,12°N, 24,73°E) was unified by Vladimirko Volodarevich (1141-1144AD) and Yaroslav Osmomysl (1153-1187AD). Its capital at Halych (*Krylos*) encompassed a 200 ha polycentric agglomeration along the Lukva and Dniester featuring the white-stone Dormition Cathedral (1157AD) and St. Panteleimon Church, housing 30,0k (30 000) inhabitants at 1200AD [4][5][6], supported by the sub-Carpathian salt-boiling centres of Kolomyia (3,5k), Zudechev (Zhydachiv, 3,0k), Sudova Vyshnia (2,5k), Drohobych (2,2k), Dolyna (2,0k), and the rock fortress of Tustan (1,2k). The Principality of Peremyshl (1133-1142AD, 49,78°N, 22,77°E) was centred on Peremyshl (*Przemysl*, 38 ha *detinets* with a stone rotunda, *palatium*, and *posad*, 9,0k at 1200AD), alongside Yaroslav (3,5k), Sanok (2,5k), and Sambir (2,2k) [5]. The Principality of Zvenyhorod (1133-1142AD, 49,73°N, 24,25°E) was centred on Zvenyhorod (45 ha citadel and waterlogged *posad* yielding Birch-Bark Letters Nos. 1-3, 10,0k at 1200AD) and Plisnesk (4,5k in 1200AD), and after c. 1256AD was superseded by Lviv (12,0k by 1300AD) [5][20]. The Principality of Terebovlia (1133-1142AD, 49,30°N, 25,69°E) was centred on Terebovlia (30 ha, 6,5k at 1200AD), Vasyliv on the Dniester (35 ha with a white-stone church, 5,0k at 1200AD), Mykulyntsi (2,2k), Zbarazh (2,0k), and Onut (1,8k) [1][9].

In the Volhynian and southern borderlands, the Principality of Volhynia (1133-1200AD, 50,85°N, 24,32°E) was centred on Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*, 75 ha rampart and *posad* complex with the 1160AD Mstislav Dormition Cathedral, 22,0k at 1200AD), Kholm (*Chelm*, Daniel's royal capital from c. 1237AD, 36 ha, 8,0k at 1240AD and 12,0k at 1300AD), Cherven (3,5k), Ugrovesk (2,8k), Liuboml (2,5k), Vsevolozh (2,2k), Suteisk (2,0k), and Volyn (*Grudek*, 1,8k) [2][22]. The Principality of Lutsk (1158-1324AD, 50,75°N, 25,33°E) was centred on Lutsk (*Luchsk*, 40 ha, 10,0k at 1200AD), Peresopnytsia (24 ha, 5,0k), Dorogobuzh-on-Horyn (22 ha, 4,5k), Kremenets (20 ha, 4,0k), Iziaslavl (2,8k in 1200AD; burned 1241AD horizon excavated by M. K. Karger), Dubno (2,8k), Shumsk (2,8k), Ostroh (2,5k), Chortoryisk (2,2k), Danyliv (2,0k), Stepan (2,0k), and Peremyl (2,0k) [7][23]. The Principality of Belz (1171-1367AD, 50,38°N, 24,01°E) was centred on Belz (28 ha, 6,0k at 1200AD), Busk (*Buzhsk*, 22 ha, 4,0k), and Sokal (1,8k) [5]. Finally, Ponizia (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya, and Transcarpathia were centred on Bakota (26 ha, 5,5k), Kamianets (22 ha, 4,0k), Medzhybizh (4,0k), Bozhsky (3,5k), Lenkivtsi (*Chern*) on the Prut (3,5k), Uzhhorod (*Ungvar*, 3,5k), Ushitsa (3,0k), Khotyn (3,0k), Kalius (2,5k), Mukachevo (2,5k), and Kuchelmin (2,0k), alongside the Pontic outposts of Tmutarakan (8,0k in 1050-1100AD) and Mangup (*Theodoro*, 6,5k in 1250-1300AD) [8][9].

The 1240-1241AD Mongol Conquests and the Post-Conquest Kingdom of Rus (1240AD - 1300AD)

On the eve of Batu Khan's western campaign (1240AD), the unified Romanovichi realm supported 1,75M (1 750,0k) inhabitants, down slightly from the 1,82M 1200AD unification peak due to the 1205-1238AD boyar and Hungarian wars of succession. During the winter campaign of December 1240AD - March 1241AD, Mongol armies stormed and burned Iziaslavl, Kolodyazhyn, Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Peresopnytsia, and Terebovlia, reducing the regional population to a post-conquest trough of 1,24M (1

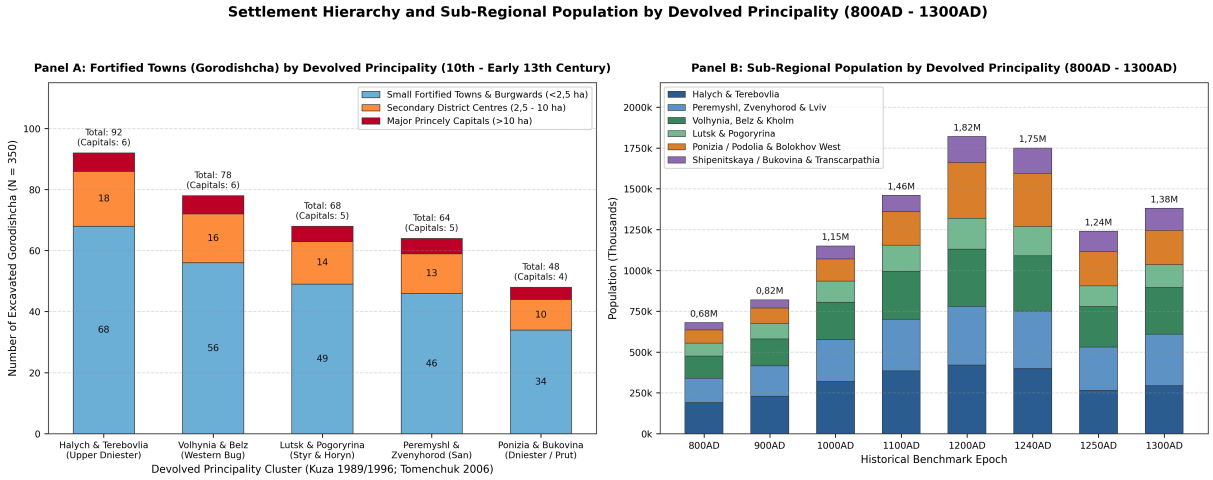


Figure 3. Settlement hierarchy and sub-regional population distribution by devolved principality in South-Western Rus (800AD - 1300AD).

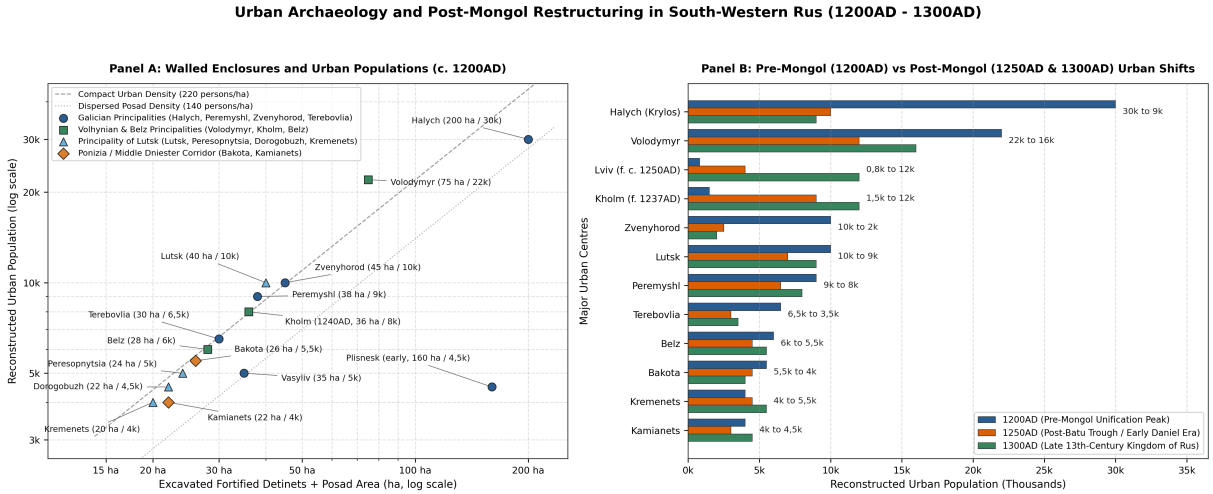


Figure 4. Urban archaeological footprint and post-Mongol demographic restructuring across South-Western Rus (1200AD - 1300AD).

240,0k) in 1250AD (-31,9% below 1200AD) [17][23]. However, because the cliff fortresses of Kremenets and Danyliv, the new royal capital at Kholm, Bakota in Ponizia, and the Carpathian mountain valleys survived intact, King Daniel Romanovich (crowned *Rex Russiae* at Dorohychyn in 1253AD), Vasilko Romanovich, Lev Danilovich (who made Lviv the supreme capital in 1272AD), and Yuri I Lvovich spearheaded a rapid demographic and urban recovery across the Kingdom of Rus, reaching 1,38M (1 380,0k) by 1300AD [1][5][22].

Table 2. Medieval sub-regional population breakdown by devolved principality cluster in South-Western Rus (1000AD - 1300AD).

Benchmark	Halych & Terebovlia	Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Lviv	Volhynia, Belz & Kholm	Principality of Lutsk	Ponizia, Bolokhov, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total
1000AD	320,0k	255,0k	230,0k	130,0k	215,0k	1,15M (1 150,0k)
1100AD	385,0k	315,0k	295,0k	160,0k	305,0k	1,46M (1 460,0k)
1150AD	405,0k	340,0k	325,0k	175,0k	405,0k	1,65M (1 650,0k)
1200AD	420,0k	360,0k	350,0k	190,0k	500,0k	1,82M (1 820,0k)
1240AD	400,0k	350,0k	340,0k	180,0k	480,0k	1,75M (1 750,0k)
1250AD	265,0k	265,0k	250,0k	125,0k	335,0k	1,24M (1 240,0k)
1300AD	295,0k	315,0k	285,0k	140,0k	345,0k	1,38M (1 380,0k)

Cross-Regional Synthesis (1000AD - 1300AD)

To ensure full demographic consistency across the historical dataset, Table 3 cross-references South-Western Rus (Galicia and Volhynia) with the northern and eastern Rus principalities documented in the companion European Russia regional review [3][15][21].

Table 3. Cross-regional demographic comparison between South-Western Rus and the northern and eastern Rus principalities (1000AD - 1300AD).

Polity / Regional Unit	1000AD Pop.	1100AD Pop.	1200AD Apogee	1250AD Trough	1300AD Pop.
Galician Principalities (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod, Terebovlia)	575,0k	700,0k	780,0k	530,0k	610,0k
Volhynian Principalities (Volodymyr, Kholm, Lutsk, Belz)	360,0k	455,0k	540,0k	375,0k	425,0k
Ponizia (Podolia), Bolokhov West, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	215,0k	305,0k	500,0k	335,0k	345,0k
Galicia and Volhynia Subtotal	1,15M	1,46M	1,82M	1,24M	1,38M
cf. Vladimir-Suzdal / Rostov (European Russia)	340,0k	510,0k	780,0k	520,0k	640,0k
cf. Novgorod & Pskov Republics (European Russia)	290,0k	380,0k	480,0k	460,0k	510,0k
cf. Principality of Smolensk (European Russia)	210,0k	275,0k	340,0k	290,0k	310,0k
cf. Total European Russia Benchmark	2,15M	2,90M	3,85M	2,80M	3,10M

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